

Fun Fact

14% of Google's workforce hasn't gone to college after they found those test scores to be worthless as a criteria for hiring.

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were developing exclusively for Android. Popular apps like Snapchat, Vine, Mailbox and Pinterest debuted on iOS and were only launched on Android after a significant amount of time had passed. New and popular apps like Periscope and Meerkat are also only available on iOS. This trend also extends to popular games like Plants vs. Zombies 2 and Cut the Rope 2.

One of the big reasons for the above trend is that developers tend to earn more money from their apps through iOS downloads. According to an AppAnnie report, developers made 60% more revenue from their iOS apps than from Android. Developers of the critically praised game, Monument Valley also revealed that 95% of Android gamers had pirated the game.

Apart from piracy and revenue, one other reason some app developers prefer iOS over Android is app discovery. App curation in iOS is much better than on Android.

The Solution: With Android becoming more popular and western markets reaching saturation, developers will soon flock to it as well. Better curation of the Play Store would also help.

Piracy is a more complex problem but Google has the ability to exploit its own ad network to offer app developers other streams of income that are more reliable, prompting developers to go for an ad-supported approach.

The Storage problem

Most budget Android phones in the market today offer 8GB or 16GB of storage, along with MicroSD card support. Now, many users believe that because of the external storage support, their storage needs will be met but that's not entirely the truth. Android itself takes up about

40% of the internal storage space and on phones that don't run Lollipop, you can't install apps on external storage. Also, if you've got personal data such as music and photos on the external card, Android doesn't let apps modify that information, rendering your microSD card completely useless and leaving you reliant on the low internal storage capacity of your device.

The Solution: Google has identified the storage issue and Lollipop allows third-party apps full control over the external storage. However, you're still unable to install apps on the microSD card directly. Google should be able to identify a process that would allow users to install apps on external storage without hampering performance and it's not like piracy will be affected either way.

The 'Resource Hunger' problem

There is a general feeling that Android phones, unless super-powered, tend to be resource hungry and often suffer from performance problems. This issue tends to be heavily anecdotal just as we saw when the 1st gen Motorola Moto G got the Android Lollipop update. While many Moto G users didn't have any issues with the update, some complained that their Moto Gs had slowed down considerably and had even started crashing.

Much of this evidence is anecdotal of course, but there's an obvious performance difference between, say, a similarly specced iOS device and an Android one. The problem is that device manufacturers boast of awesome specs on paper, but hide the specs that matter, such as RAM speed, thermal throttling, etc.

The above issue is not Android's fault and is similar to the issue one faces when purchasing a Windows PC. Unless you have deep and detailed knowledge of specs, it'll be quite hard to adjust expectations based on reported specs alone.

Another major issue with Android phones is RAM management. The reason why you're already seeing Android phones with 3GB of RAM is because of

